



# LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



## Cyberattack on Russian tech firm Astral disrupts business, government services for week

### Threat Actor Profile

|                       |                      |
|-----------------------|----------------------|
| <b>Classification</b> | TLP:CLEAR            |
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TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | Cyberattack on Russian tech firm Astral disrupts business, government services for week - Threat Actor Profile

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# Cyberattack on Russian tech firm Astral disrupts business, government services for week

## 1. Executive Summary

Lost Boys Cyber assesses with medium confidence that the June 2026 disruption at Kaluga Astral / Astral Group was a targeted cyberattack against a Russian digital-services provider whose platforms sit in a critical business-and-government trust chain. Astral reported that a series of hacker attacks beginning 9 June forced the company to stop or degrade multiple services while recovery teams and Russian government information-security authorities investigated the incident. Public reporting did not attribute the intrusion to a named actor, and no public technical root cause, malware sample, command-and-control infrastructure, or confirmed data-theft evidence was available at the time of this review.

The business impact was material. The Record, citing Astral statements and customer complaints, reported disruption to services used for tax reporting, electronic document management, customer portals, corporate email, electronic HR document management, cash-register operations, regulated-goods sales, and digital-certificate-based authentication. Astral stated that its internal investigation found no evidence that customer data had leaked or been compromised, but restoration took roughly a week because the company returned each service only after a security review.

This incident is not a conventional threat-actor profile with a named adversary and stable infrastructure. It is instead a profile of an unattributed disruptive operation against a high-dependency trust-service provider. Defenders should treat the Astral incident as a useful case study for business-process concentration risk: a single service provider outage can degrade fiscal reporting, electronic document exchange, digital signing, point-of-sale/fiscal-data workflows, and authentication flows for many downstream organizations even when no control-system impact is reported.

| Field                  | Assessment                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Report ID              | LBC-TAP-2026-013                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Report Family          | Threat Actor Profile                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Primary Analytic Focus | Unattributed disruptive cyberattack against Kaluga Astral / Astral Group and downstream business/government service dependency risk                                                                                                 |
| Source Trigger         | The Record article published 2026-06-15, corroborated with Astral's Russian-language incident notice and Russian industry reporting                                                                                                 |
| Affected Organization  | Kaluga Astral / Astral Group, a Russian software and digital-services provider                                                                                                                                                      |
| Reported Impact Window | Attack began 2026-06-09; full restoration expected around 2026-06-16 according to Astral statements                                                                                                                                 |
| Reported Impact        | Service outages/degradation affecting tax reporting, EDI/EDO, fiscal-data operations, marking/regulated-goods workflows, electronic-signature issuance/authentication, customer portals, corporate email, and HR document workflows |
| Attribution            | Unknown; no public evidence links the June 2026 incident to a named group                                                                                                                                                           |
| Data Exposure          | Astral stated no leaks or compromise were found during its internal review; public reporting did not provide independent forensic proof                                                                                             |
| Priority               | High for organizations dependent on managed trust, digital                                                                                                                                                                          |

|            |                                                                                                                                       |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|            | certificate, fiscal-data, EDI/EDO, and government-reporting service providers                                                         |
| Confidence | Medium overall; high for service disruption based on primary company statements, low for actor identity and technical intrusion chain |

Lost Boys Cyber recommends that clients use the Astral incident to review third-party resilience, digital-certificate contingency procedures, provider status monitoring, service-account governance, and business continuity for reporting, invoicing, signing, regulated-goods, and fiscal-data workflows. The most actionable defensive lesson is not who executed the attack; it is how quickly provider-side security incidents can cascade into authentication, compliance, revenue, and operational processes.

## 2. Intelligence Requirement

This report answers the following intelligence requirement:

| Requirement                    | Answer                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary question               | What does the Astral incident reveal about threat activity against trust-service and digital business-process providers?                                                                                       |
| Secondary question             | How should defenders monitor, hunt, and prepare for disruptive attacks against third-party EDI, fiscal-data, electronic-signature, and government-reporting services?                                          |
| Operational decision supported | Whether downstream organizations should treat provider outages as simple vendor availability events or as potential cyber incidents requiring identity, certificate, data-flow, and business-continuity triage |
| Time horizon                   | Immediate review of dependency exposure and provider outage playbooks; 30-90 day uplift of third-party monitoring, certificate contingency, and service-account controls                                       |

Analytic assumptions used in this report:

- Public reporting is sufficient to confirm a significant service disruption and Astral's public cyberattack claim, but not sufficient to prove actor identity or intrusion method.
- Russian-language vendor and industry reporting is used as source material, but operational details may be constrained by the involvement of Russian government information-security authorities.
- Detection content below is designed for organizations that depend on comparable trust-service providers, not for direct monitoring inside Astral's environment.
- No leaked data, credentials, malware samples, victim logs, or attacker infrastructure were reviewed or reproduced in this assessment.
- Where this report refers to EDI/EDO, electronic signatures, fiscal-data operators, and regulated-goods marking, map those concepts to the local jurisdictional equivalents in the client's environment.

### Source summary

The primary source is The Record's 15 June 2026 article, "Cyberattack on Russian tech firm Astral disrupts business, government services for week," by Daryna Antoniuk. The article reports that Kaluga Astral said it had been hit by a cyberattack earlier in June, that several services were disrupted for about a week, and that recovery was deliberately gated by security checks. The Record also notes that Russian government agencies were involved in the investigation and that Astral stated it found no evidence of customer-data leakage or compromise.

Astral's own incident notice states that on 9 June its resources were hit by a targeted series of hacker attacks, causing a number of services to stop. Astral said government information-security authorities began investigating from the start of the incident,

customer data remained safe, protection was strengthened, and each service was returned only after a full security review. The notice stated that most services were already operating normally and that Astral expected the OFD and remaining services to return on 16 June.

Russian industry coverage from emchd.ru summarized customer-facing impact across electronic document management, fiscal-data operator services, electronic-signature issuance, marking/regulated-goods services, Web registrar functions, and authentication/signing flows. It also reported that some services, including 1C-EDO and EPD, did not fully stop but experienced temporary authorization and document-signing issues tied to certificate-revocation-list availability.

| Source element                               | Relevance                                                                                                                                                                     | Lost Boys Cyber evaluation                                                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The Record / Recorded Future News article    | Primary English-language reporting; includes company statements, affected workflows, past attack context, and customer complaint summary                                      | Credible security-media source; relies on public statements and customer complaints rather than direct forensic data |
| Astral official incident notice              | Primary victim statement confirming targeted hacker attacks, government investigation, no observed data compromise, security-gated restoration, and expected 16 June recovery | High relevance for incident timeline and company position; limited technical detail due to investigation constraints |
| emchd.ru Russian industry article            | Adds operational impact detail for EDI/EDO, OFD, marking, electronic signature, Web registrar, CRL/authentication, and downstream customer pain points                        | Useful sector context; should be treated as secondary reporting, not forensic proof                                  |
| Customer complaints referenced by The Record | Describe practical business interruption: cash-register operations, regulated goods, portals, email, HR document management, and certificates                                 | Valuable for impact assessment; individual complaint details were not independently verified by Lost Boys Cyber      |
| Historical Astral attack context             | The Record notes a 2022 DDoS against Astral services and a 2023 IT Army of Ukraine target listing                                                                             | Useful background; no evidence publicly links either item to the June 2026 incident                                  |

### Confidence assessment

| Judgment                                                                                 | Confidence | Rationale                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Astral experienced a cyberattack beginning around 9 June 2026                            | High       | Confirmed by Astral's public statement and The Record's reporting                                               |
| Multiple downstream business and government-service workflows were disrupted or degraded | High       | Supported by Astral, The Record, and Russian industry coverage; impact categories are consistent across sources |
| Customer data was not leaked or compromised                                              | Medium     | Astral publicly stated no evidence of leakage or compromise; no independent forensic report was available       |
| The attack was conducted by a known named group                                          | Low        | No public attribution, technical indicators, or claimed responsibility were available in reviewed sources       |
| The attack was a DDoS-only event                                                         | Low        | Astral described a targeted series of hacker attacks and a security-reviewed restoration                        |

|                                                                                                         |      |                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                                                         |      | process; public details do not support reducing the incident to DDoS only                                                                                                              |
| The incident created meaningful supply-chain and trust-service resilience risk for downstream customers | High | Disrupted workflows included digital certificates, fiscal-data operations, EDI/EDO, and reporting functions that downstream organizations rely on for compliance and revenue processes |

### Intelligence gaps

- No public root-cause statement, attack vector, malware family, intrusion timeline, affected host count, or forensic report was available.
- No validated attacker infrastructure, payload hash, phishing domain, exploit chain, or compromised credential set was available.
- The extent of internal segmentation between Astral's EDI/EDO, OFD, certificate, portal, and corporate services is unknown.
- It is unclear whether the incident involved destructive actions, ransomware, data exfiltration, credential theft, web compromise, denial-of-service, or a combination of techniques.
- The role and scope of Russian government information-security authorities in the investigation were not detailed publicly.

## 4. Key Findings

| ID    | Finding                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Defensive implication                                                                                                                                                         | Priority    |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| KF-01 | A targeted cyberattack against Astral disrupted trust-dependent business services for about a week.                                                                                                     | Treat third-party EDI, fiscal-data, certificate, and reporting platforms as critical dependencies, not ordinary SaaS conveniences.                                            | High        |
| KF-02 | Affected workflows reportedly included cash registers/fiscal data, regulated-goods sales, customer portals, corporate email, electronic HR document management, and digital-certificate authentication. | Business continuity plans must cover revenue, compliance, signing, authentication, and regulated-product workflows when a provider goes offline.                              | High        |
| KF-03 | Astral stated no evidence of customer-data compromise was found, but public technical evidence remains limited.                                                                                         | Downstream customers should assume uncertainty: preserve logs, monitor for phishing and account misuse, and validate data flows without overstating confirmed breach status.  | Medium-High |
| KF-04 | Recovery was deliberately slowed by per-service security review and government investigation.                                                                                                           | Provider-side incident response can create long service windows even when recovery work is active; SLAs should include cyber-contingency procedures and status communication. | High        |
| KF-05 | Historical context includes a 2022 DDoS that affected Astral reporting processes and a 2023                                                                                                             | Avoid unsupported attribution; track regional hacktivist and state-aligned interest as                                                                                        | Medium      |

|       |                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                            |      |
|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
|       | IT Army of Ukraine target listing, but neither is linked to this incident.                                                             | background risk only.                                                                                                      |      |
| KF-06 | Certificate-revocation-list and signing/authentication problems can create cascading failures across otherwise unrelated applications. | Monitor PKI, OCSP/CRL availability, token/signing services, and fallback authentication paths as operational dependencies. | High |
| KF-07 | The incident demonstrates concentration risk in digital-government and compliance ecosystems.                                          | Identify single points of provider dependency and define manual or alternate-provider procedures before the next outage.   | High |

## 5. Threat Context

Astral Group / Kaluga Astral develops software and services for electronic document management, digital reporting to government agencies, electronic signatures, fiscal-data operations, and cybersecurity. The Record reported that the company serves government institutions, banks, and large state-owned enterprises, including Russian Post and Moscow public transport operator Mosgortrans. That customer profile makes Astral a valuable target for adversaries seeking broad disruptive effect, intelligence collection, or geopolitical signaling.

The most important threat-context lesson is provider concentration. A successful attack on a trust-service provider can disrupt multiple downstream processes that customers experience as unrelated failures: inability to submit reports, issue or validate digital signatures, process fiscal receipts, sell regulated goods, access portals, or complete HR-document workflows. In many environments, these services are treated as back-office or compliance platforms. During an outage, they can become blockers for revenue, legal obligations, customer support, and executive decision-making.

| Threat dimension                | Relevance to Astral incident                                                                                                             | Defensive interpretation                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Trust-service dependency        | Astral supports certificate, reporting, EDI/EDO, OFD, and related workflows                                                              | Include trust-service providers in critical third-party inventories and tabletop exercises                               |
| Regional geopolitical context   | Russian technology providers remain targets for criminal, hacktivist, and state-linked activity during the Russia-Ukraine cyber conflict | Maintain attribution discipline; use regional context to prioritize monitoring, not to assign blame without evidence     |
| Business-process disruption     | Customer complaints included sales, portals, email, HR, reporting, and digital certificates                                              | Map provider outages to business processes, not only to IT service names                                                 |
| PKI and signing reliance        | Authentication and document-signing issues were publicly reported                                                                        | Monitor certificate validation dependencies, CRL/OCSP access, signing token services, and emergency signing alternatives |
| Provider-side incident response | Astral restored each service only after security review                                                                                  | Expect security-gated recovery windows and require provider incident-status channels in vendor governance                |
| Unattributed operation          | No group claimed responsibility in reviewed public sources                                                                               | Hunt for techniques and impacts rather than actor-specific IOCs                                                          |

The Record also notes prior incidents and targeting interest: Astral disclosed in 2022 that a DDoS attack disrupted services and interfered with customer reporting processes, and in 2023 the IT Army of Ukraine listed Astral among intended targets. These items establish that Astral has been visible in the regional cyber conflict environment, but there is no public evidence linking either to the June 2026 incident. Lost Boys Cyber assesses that unsupported attribution would reduce, not improve, defensive value.

### MITRE ATT&CK mapping

The following mapping is a defensive hypothesis based on public impact descriptions and common tradecraft for provider disruption. It is not a claim that these techniques were confirmed inside Astral.

| Tactic                         | Technique                                                            | Relevance to Astral scenario                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Initial Access                 | External Remote Services (T1133)                                     | Provider portals, VPNs, remote administration, and support interfaces are common access paths for service-provider environments.             |
| Initial Access                 | Phishing (T1566)                                                     | Trust-service providers are attractive phishing targets because credentials can expose customer-support, signing, and reporting workflows.   |
| Credential Access              | Unsecured Credentials (T1552)                                        | Service accounts for EDI, certificate, OFD, and portal integrations often hold broad access if secrets are weakly governed.                  |
| Discovery                      | System Service Discovery (T1007) / Network Service Discovery (T1046) | Attackers disrupting multiple services may enumerate service dependencies, authentication paths, and recovery-critical infrastructure.       |
| Lateral Movement               | Remote Services (T1021)                                              | Movement between portal, mail, certificate, EDI, and fiscal-data environments would explain multi-service impact if segmentation is weak.    |
| Collection                     | Data from Information Repositories (T1213)                           | Customer portals, document-management platforms, and reporting systems may hold sensitive business documents and regulated data.             |
| Exfiltration                   | Exfiltration Over Web Service (T1567)                                | No exfiltration is confirmed, but provider environments should monitor for bulk transfer during incidents involving document stores.         |
| Impact                         | Network Denial of Service (T1498) / Service Stop (T1489)             | Prior Astral disruption involved DDoS; June 2026 public impact involved service stoppage/degradation, though method is unknown.              |
| Impact                         | Data Encrypted for Impact (T1486) / Data Destruction (T1485)         | Not confirmed; include in hunts because multi-service restoration and security-gated recovery can accompany ransomware/destructive activity. |
| ICS-adjacent / Business Impact | Inhibit System Recovery (T1490)                                      | Downstream customers can lose business-process continuity when provider-side                                                                 |



|  |  |                                                                |
|--|--|----------------------------------------------------------------|
|  |  | recovery, CRL, signing, or portal services remain unavailable. |
|--|--|----------------------------------------------------------------|

### Indicators, observables, and source limitations

No validated malware, attacker IP, command-and-control endpoint, exploit string, credential, or leaked customer data was available in reviewed public reporting. Treat the following as observables for defensive scoping and business-continuity planning rather than confirmed compromise IOCs.

| Indicator / Observable                                                | Type                        | Defensive Use                                                                                               | Confidence  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Kaluga Astral / Astral Group                                          | Affected provider           | Track provider status, customer advisories, and dependency exposure                                         | High        |
| 2026-06-09 attack start                                               | Incident timeline marker    | Bound log review and business-process impact timelines                                                      | High        |
| 2026-06-16 expected full restoration                                  | Recovery timeline marker    | Compare customer-side outage reports and provider status updates                                            | Medium-High |
| Electronic document management / EDI / EDO service disruption         | Business-process observable | Identify stalled document exchange, failed API calls, and alternate procedures                              | High        |
| OFD / fiscal-data operator service disruption                         | Business-process observable | Review cash-register/fiscal-receipt submission failures and retry queues                                    | High        |
| Electronic-signature issuance and certificate-authentication problems | Trust-service observable    | Review signing failures, CRL/OCSP availability, certificate renewal delays, and authentication errors       | High        |
| Customer portal and corporate email issues                            | Access-service observable   | Review login failures, suspicious password resets, and helpdesk spikes                                      | Medium      |
| No confirmed data leak per Astral                                     | Source limitation           | Avoid asserting breach without evidence; still preserve logs and monitor for follow-on abuse                | Medium      |
| Unknown actor and method                                              | Source limitation           | Prioritize behavior-based hunts, third-party continuity, and identity controls over actor-specific blocking | High        |

## 6. Detection and Hunting

Detection and hunting for this case should be applied in two ways. First, organizations operating comparable trust-service, EDI/EDO, certificate, fiscal-data, or regulated-reporting platforms should hunt for provider-side intrusion behaviors. Second, downstream customers should hunt for dependency failure, credential misuse, and follow-on social engineering triggered by a provider outage.

### 6.1 Detection coverage plan

| Coverage area | Telemetry source | High-value signals | Why it matters |
|---------------|------------------|--------------------|----------------|
|---------------|------------------|--------------------|----------------|

|                                              |                                                                                               |                                                                                                 |                                                                                       |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                              |                                                                                               |                                                                                                 |                                                                                       |
| Provider integration failures                | API gateway, application logs, message queues, EDI/EDO connectors, OFD/fiscal-data connectors | Sudden spike in failed submissions, retry queues, timeout codes, certificate-validation errors  | Converts vague outage reports into scoped business-process impact                     |
| Digital certificate and signing dependencies | PKI logs, OCSP/CRL monitoring, HSM/signing service logs, identity provider logs               | CRL/OCSP unreachable, signing failures, certificate issuance failures, unusual token errors     | Public reporting included authentication and signing problems tied to certificates    |
| Service-account abuse                        | IAM, PAM, VPN, Linux/Windows auth logs, SaaS admin audit logs                                 | Interactive login by service account, new source IP, impossible travel, off-hours admin actions | Trust-service integrations often depend on powerful non-human accounts                |
| Bulk document or customer-data access        | DLP, database audit, object-store logs, document-management logs                              | Large export, unusual query breadth, mass downloads, archive creation, compression tools        | Provider platforms can hold sensitive business documents and regulated records        |
| Destructive or ransomware staging            | EDR, Sysmon, Windows Event Logs, backup telemetry                                             | vssadmin/wbadmin/bcdedit, service stop, backup deletion, mass file rename, encryption tools     | No ransomware is confirmed, but multi-service outages justify impact hunting          |
| Follow-on phishing and fraud                 | Email security, web proxy, helpdesk, identity logs                                            | Provider-themed lures, fake status pages, credential-reset pretexts, invoice/reporting urgency  | Provider incidents create plausible social-engineering hooks for downstream customers |
| Third-party status anomalies                 | Vendor status APIs, synthetic transactions, external monitoring                               | Provider unavailable while local systems are healthy, inconsistent regional availability        | Helps separate internal failure from provider-side cyber incident                     |

## 6.2 Sigma: service-account interactive login during provider outage

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>title: Service Account Interactive Login During Trust Provider Outage</p> <p>id: 5b7e1794-0037-4c94-bf59-lbc-astral-provider-001</p> <p>status: experimental</p> <p>description: Detects interactive logon activity by service accounts used for EDI, certificate, reporting, fiscal-data, or provider integrations during a third-party outage window. Tune account name patterns and approved bastions locally.</p> <p>author: Lost Boys Cyber</p> <p>date: 2026-06-17</p> <p>references:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- <a href="https://therecord.media/cyberattack-on-russian-tech-firm-astral-disrupts-business-government-services">https://therecord.media/cyberattack-on-russian-tech-firm-astral-disrupts-business-government-services</a></li> </ul> <p>logsource:</p> <p>product: windows</p> <p>service: security</p> <p>detection:</p> <p>selection_logon:</p> <p>EventID:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- 4624</li> </ul> <p>LogonType:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- 2</li> <li>- 10</li> </ul> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

```

- 11
selection_account:
  TargetUserName|contains:
    - 'svc_edi'
    - 'svc_edo'
    - 'svc_ofd'
    - 'svc_cert'
    - 'svc_sign'
    - 'svc_reporting'
    - 'svc_provider'
filter_approved_hosts:
  WorkstationName|contains:
    - 'BASTION'
    - 'JUMP'
    - 'PAM'
condition: selection_logon and selection_account and not filter_approved_hosts
fields:
  - TimeCreated
  - TargetUserName
  - WorkstationName
  - IpAddress
  - LogonType
  - AuthenticationPackageName
falsepositives:
  - Approved break-glass recovery activity through a named bastion
  - Legacy service account incorrectly configured for interactive maintenance
level: high

```

### 6.3 KQL: certificate, signing, and provider integration failure spike

```

let lookback = 14d;
let baselineStart = ago(lookback);
let outageWindow = 24h;
let IntegrationKeywords = dynamic(["astral", "provider", "edi", "edo", "ofd", "fiscal", "certificate",
"cert", "crl", "ocsp", "signature", "signing", "reporting"]);
AppEvents
| where TimeGenerated >= baselineStart
| where tostring(Name) has_any (IntegrationKeywords) or tostring(Properties) has_any
(IntegrationKeywords)
| extend ErrorText = strcat(Name, " ", tostring(Properties))
| where ErrorText has_any ("timeout", "unavailable", "failed", "certificate", "revocation", "CRL",
"OCSP", "signature", "auth")
| summarize Failures=count(), FirstSeen=min(TimeGenerated), LastSeen=max(TimeGenerated),
SampleErrors=make_set(ErrorText, 5) by bin(TimeGenerated, 1h), AppRoleName
| summarize RecentFailures=sumif(Failures, TimeGenerated >= ago(outageWindow)),
BaselineHourlyAvg=avgif(Failures, TimeGenerated < ago(outageWindow)), Samples=make_set(SampleErrors, 5)
by AppRoleName
| extend SpikeRatio = todouble(RecentFailures) / iff(BaselineHourlyAvg < 1, 1.0, BaselineHourlyAvg)
| where RecentFailures >= 25 and SpikeRatio >= 5
| order by RecentFailures desc

```

### 6.4 SPL: provider-themed phishing after outage reporting

```

index=email earliest=-14d
("Astral" OR "provider outage" OR "certificate renewal" OR "digital signature" OR "tax reporting" OR
"fiscal data" OR "EDI" OR "EDO" OR "OFD")
| eval lowered=lower(subject." ".body)
| where match(lowered, "(urgent|restore|reconnect|renew|certificate|password|portal|invoice|reporting|
signature)")
| stats count min(_time) as first_seen max(_time) as last_seen values(sender) as senders values(url) as
urls by recipient subject
| where count >= 2 OR mvcount(urls) > 0
| convert ctime(first_seen) ctime(last_seen)
| sort - count

```

### 6.5 KQL: suspicious bulk access to document or reporting repositories

```

let lookback = 14d;

```

```

let SensitiveApps = dynamic(["document", "edi", "edo", "reporting", "fiscal", "ofd", "signature",
"certificate", "portal"]);
CloudAppEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(lookback)
| where Application has_any (SensitiveApps) or ObjectName has_any (SensitiveApps)
| where ActionType has_any ("Download", "Export", "Read", "FileDownloaded", "ArchiveCreated",
"SearchQueryPerformed")
| summarize EventCount=count(), Objects=dcount(ObjectName), Apps=make_set(Application, 10),
Actions=make_set(ActionType, 10), SampleObjects=make_set(ObjectName, 10) by AccountId, bin(Timestamp,
1h), IPAddress
| where EventCount > 100 or Objects > 50
| join kind=leftouter (
    IdentityLogonEvents
    | where Timestamp > ago(lookback)
    | summarize FirstLogon=min(Timestamp), LogonIPs=make_set(IPAddress, 10) by AccountId
) on AccountId
| order by EventCount desc

```

## 6.6 Hunt hypotheses

| Hypothesis                                                                                              | Data required                                                         | Success criteria                                                                        | Follow-up action                                                                   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Provider outage created local business-process failures before teams recognized a third-party incident. | Application logs, queue depths, support tickets, provider status data | Failure spike aligns with provider outage and not local code deploys                    | Document dependency map and automate provider status alerting                      |
| Service accounts tied to provider integrations were abused or overprivileged.                           | IAM/PAM logs, service account inventory, VPN and endpoint logs        | Interactive logins, new source IPs, broad permissions, or credential reuse found        | Rotate secrets, enforce PAM, remove interactive rights, restrict source networks   |
| Certificate validation or signing infrastructure is a single point of failure.                          | OCSP/CRL monitors, HSM/signing service logs, identity provider events | CRL/OCSP/signing failures correlate with business disruption                            | Implement cached validation, emergency signing paths, and outage runbooks          |
| Actors used provider outage news for credential phishing.                                               | Email/web proxy, helpdesk tickets, identity logs                      | Themed lures, fake status pages, or password-reset spikes appear after public reporting | Block domains, warn users, harden reset workflows, review MFA events               |
| Provider platform compromise included bulk data access despite no public breach confirmation.           | Document-management audit, DLP, database logs, object storage events  | Unusual exports or broad reads during the incident window                               | Preserve evidence, notify legal, engage provider, and scope regulatory obligations |

## 7. Recommendations

| Priority | Owner                            | Action                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Target timing |
|----------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Critical | Identity / Platform Engineering  | Inventory all service accounts used for EDI/EDO, fiscal-data, digital-signature, certificate, reporting, and provider API integrations; remove interactive logon rights and rotate secrets where provider-side outage or compromise is suspected. | 0-7 days      |
| Critical | Business Continuity / Operations | Document manual or alternate workflows for tax reporting,                                                                                                                                                                                         | 0-14 days     |

|             |                           |                                                                                                                                                                                     |            |
|-------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
|             |                           | invoice/document exchange, digital signing, cash-register/fiscal-data submission, regulated-goods sales, and certificate renewal.                                                   |            |
| High        | Security Operations       | Add outage-triggered hunts for certificate validation failures, bulk document access, provider-themed phishing, and service-account anomalies.                                      | 0-14 days  |
| High        | Third-Party Risk          | Require critical trust-service providers to supply cyber-specific incident communication channels, security-gated recovery expectations, and RTO/RPO assumptions for cyber outages. | 30 days    |
| High        | PKI / IAM                 | Monitor OCSP/CRL, signing, and certificate-issuance dependencies as production services; alert on validation failures and unusual issuance/renewal patterns.                        | 30 days    |
| High        | Architecture              | Segment provider integration middleware from identity, finance, HR, and document repositories; restrict egress to provider endpoints and approved proxies.                          | 30-90 days |
| Medium-High | Legal / Compliance        | Pre-stage regulatory and contractual decision trees for missed reporting deadlines, fiscal-data delays, digital-signature outages, and provider cyber incidents.                    | 30-90 days |
| Medium      | Communications / Helpdesk | Prepare user-facing language for provider outages that distinguishes confirmed internal compromise from third-party dependency failure.                                             | 30 days    |
| Medium      | Detection Engineering     | Convert the Sigma, KQL, and SPL starting logic in this report into platform-native analytics and tune them with local provider names and account patterns.                          | 30 days    |

## Implementation notes:

- Do not wait for a provider to publish technical indicators before starting local triage. Provider outage windows are enough to trigger dependency and identity checks.

- Treat digital certificate validation, document signing, and reporting workflows as operational dependencies with measurable health checks.
- Preserve logs around provider outage windows even when the provider states that no data compromise is evident; later regulatory or insurance review may require proof of local impact.
- Avoid unsupported public attribution in executive communications. Emphasize confirmed service impact, business dependency, and defensive actions.
- Use tabletop exercises to test who owns decisions when reporting, fiscal-data, signing, and customer-facing workflows fail simultaneously.

## 8. References

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